Effect of Smartphone Use on the Study Habits of University Students: A Case Study of IUBAT

Md. Mainul Islam (ID: 23203037)
Jannati Ferdous (ID: 23303157)

A Thesis in the Partial Fulfillment of the Requirements
for the Award of Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering (BCSE)



Department of Computer Science and Engineering
College of Engineering and Technology
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

Fall 2026

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The thesis has been examined and approved,

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Prof Dr. Utpal Kanti Das
Chairman & Professor
Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

_____

Dr. Hasibur Rashid Chayon
Coordinator and Associate Professor
Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

_____

[Supervisor Name]
[Supervisor Designation]
Dept. of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

Fall 2026

LETTER OF TRANSMITTAL

8th November, 2026

The Chairman
Thesis Defense Committee
College of Engineering and Technology (CEAT)
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology
4 Embankment Drive Road, Sector 10, Uttara Model Town
Dhaka 1230, Bangladesh

Subject: Submission of the thesis report.

Sir,

With due respect, we are pleased to submit our report titled **"Effect of Smartphone Use on the Study Habits of University Students: A Case Study of IUBAT"** as a part of the requirements for the Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering (BCSE) program.

Working on this topic helped us understand how a research report is planned and written. We learned how to define a problem, set clear objectives and explain our approach in simple steps. We hope the report meets your expectations.

We would be very grateful if you kindly go through the report and give us your valuable feedback.

Thank you.

Md. Mainul Islam
ID: 23203037

Jannati Ferdous
ID: 23303157

STUDENT'S DECLARATION

We, Md. Mainul Islam (ID: 23203037) and Jannati Ferdous (ID: 23303157), are students of the Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering (BCSE) program under the College of Engineering and Technology (CEAT) of IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology. We declare that this report, titled **"Effect of Smartphone Use on the Study Habits of University Students: A Case Study of IUBAT"**, has been prepared by us as a part of our thesis course.

The work in this report is our own. Where we have used ideas or information from other sources, we have mentioned them in the references.

This report has not been submitted anywhere else for any other degree, award or presentation.

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Md. Mainul Islam
ID: 23203037

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Jannati Ferdous
ID: 23303157

ACKNOWLEDGMENTS

First of all, we thank Almighty Allah for giving us the strength and patience to complete this report.

We would like to express our sincere gratitude to our course teacher and thesis supervisor for the guidance, advice and encouragement we received throughout this work. The clear instructions on how to plan and write a thesis report made our task much easier.

We are also thankful to the Chairman and the Coordinator of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IUBAT, for their support. We thank all our teachers, who taught us the basics that we used in this work.

Finally, we thank our families and friends for their love, prayers and support. Without them, this work would not have been possible.

SUPERVISOR'S CERTIFICATION

This is to certify that the thesis report titled **"Effect of Smartphone Use on the Study Habits of University Students: A Case Study of IUBAT"** has been prepared by Md. Mainul Islam (ID: 23203037) and Jannati Ferdous (ID: 23303157) of IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology, as a part of the requirements of the Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering (BCSE) program.

The report was prepared under my supervision. To the best of my knowledge and according to the declaration of the students, no part of this report has been submitted anywhere for any degree, diploma or certificate.

The students are allowed to submit the report. I wish them every success in their future work.

Thesis Supervisor

_____

[Supervisor Name]
[Supervisor Designation]
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

DEPARTMENT'S CERTIFICATION

On behalf of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering, IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology, we confirm that the thesis report **"Effect of Smartphone Use on the Study Habits of University Students: A Case Study of IUBAT"** for the Bachelor of Computer Science and Engineering (BCSE) degree was duly presented by Md. Mainul Islam (ID: 23203037) and Jannati Ferdous (ID: 23303157) and approved by the department.

_____

[Supervisor Name]
Supervisor, [Designation]
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

_____

Dr. Hasibur Rashid Chayon
Coordinator and Associate Professor
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

_____

Prof. Dr. Utpal Kanti Das
Chairman & Professor
Department of Computer Science and Engineering
IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology

ABSTRACT

Smartphones have become a part of daily life for university students. They help students to search for information, join online classes and talk with teachers. At the same time, they bring many distractions such as social media, games and videos. Many teachers and parents believe that long hours on the phone reduce the time and focus that students give to their studies, but this belief is not clearly tested for the students of our own university.

This thesis studies the relationship between smartphone use and the study habits of undergraduate students. The scope of the work is limited to the students of IUBAT - International University of Business Agriculture and Technology. The problem we address is that there is little local evidence on how much time students spend on their phones and how this is connected with their study time, concentration and assignment completion.

Our approach is a quantitative survey. We will prepare a short questionnaire and collect responses from a sample of students of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering. The data will be analyzed with simple descriptive statistics, such as average and percentage, and a correlation test to see whether more phone use goes with weaker study habits.

This report presents the introduction chapter, which explains the background, the research gap, the research questions, the objectives, the hypotheses and the plan of the full thesis. The findings and their meaning will be reported in the later chapters after the data are collected. We expect the results to help students manage their phone time and to help teachers give better advice.

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Chapter I. Introduction

1.1 Background of the Study

The smartphone is one of the most used devices in the world today. A student can use it to read a lecture note, watch a tutorial, send an email to a teacher or join an online class. In Bangladesh, mobile internet has become cheaper and more available, so almost every university student now owns a smartphone and carries it all day.

The same device also brings many distractions. Social media, short videos, games and chat messages call for attention again and again. A student who sits down to study may check the phone many times in one hour. Each check is short, but together they can break the focus and reduce the real study time.

Study habits mean the regular ways in which a student studies, such as how many hours they study, how well they can focus and whether they finish their work on time. Good study habits are strongly linked with learning and with academic success. For this reason, it is worth asking how the use of the smartphone is connected with the study habits of university students.

1.2 Review of Related Literature

Researchers in many countries have studied the effect of mobile phones on students. Some studies report that heavy phone use is linked with lower concentration, less sleep and weaker academic performance. Other studies report that phones can support learning when they are used for educational purposes, such as searching for information or watching lessons. So the results of earlier work are mixed, and the effect seems to depend on how the phone is used and not only on how long it is used.

Most of the available studies were done in other countries, in different school systems and with different student groups. The habits of students depend on their culture, their courses and their living conditions. Therefore, the findings of one country cannot be taken as correct for another without checking. A detailed review of the selected studies will be given in Chapter II.

1.3 Overview of the Current Situation

At present, teachers and parents often talk about phone addiction among students, and many classrooms have their own rules for phone use. However, these rules are mostly based on opinion. In many cases nobody has asked the students how much time they spend on the phone, what they do with it and how it changes their studies.

Students also have different views. Some say the phone helps them to study, because they can find answers quickly. Others admit that they lose a lot of time on social media, especially at night. Both views can be true at the same time, which is why a clear and simple study of the actual habits is needed.

1.4 Research Gap and Problem Statement

From the discussion above we can see a gap. There is a lot of general talk about phones and studies, but there is very little local evidence from the students of our university. We do not know how many hours IUBAT students use their phones, and we do not know whether more use is connected with less study time and weaker focus.

The problem of this study can therefore be stated in one line: the relationship between the smartphone use and the study habits of university students is not clearly known in our local setting. This study tries to fill the gap with a small and simple survey.

1.5 Importance of the Research

The topic is important for three groups of people. For students, the results can show how phone time is connected with their own study time, so they can plan their day in a better way. For teachers, the results can give real data to support their advice and classroom rules. For the university, the results can help in planning awareness programs about healthy use of technology.

The study is also simple and low in cost. It needs only a questionnaire and a basic analysis, so it can be repeated by other departments or other universities. In this way, our small study can become a first step for bigger studies in the future.

1.6 Research Questions

This thesis tries to answer the following questions:

1. How many hours per day do university students use their smartphones, and what do they mostly use them for?
2. Is there a relationship between the daily smartphone use and the daily study time of students?
3. Is there a relationship between the smartphone use and the concentration of students and their ability to finish assignments on time?

1.7 Aim and Objectives

The main aim of this thesis is to find out how the use of smartphones is related to the study habits of university students of IUBAT. To reach this aim, we set the following objectives:

- To measure the average daily smartphone use of the students.
- To find the main purposes for which students use their phones.
- To measure the study time, concentration and assignment completion of the students.
- To test whether more phone use is connected with weaker study habits.
- To give simple suggestions for the healthy use of smartphones in studies.

1.8 Hypotheses

A hypothesis is a statement that can be tested with data. Based on the research questions, we make the following two hypotheses for this study:

- H1: Students who use smartphones for more hours per day have less daily study time.
- H2: Students who use smartphones for more hours per day report weaker concentration while studying.

We will test both hypotheses with the survey data. If the data do not support a hypothesis, we will report that honestly, because a clear negative result is also a useful finding.

1.9 Scope and Definition of Terms

The scope of this study is limited to the undergraduate students of the Department of Computer Science and Engineering at IUBAT. We study only the smartphone use and three parts of study habits: study time, concentration and assignment completion. We do not study the health of students, their family background or their exam marks. The variables of the study are shown in Table 1.1.

Table 1.1 Main variables of the study

Variable	Type	How it will be measured
Daily smartphone use	Independent	Hours of use per day, reported by the student
Social media use	Independent	Hours per day spent on social media apps
Study time	Dependent	Hours of self-study per day
Concentration	Dependent	Rating scale from 1 to 5 in the questionnaire
Assignment completion	Dependent	How often work is finished on time

Table 1.1 lists the variables that this study will measure and how each one will be measured.

Some terms used in this report are explained below to make the reading easy.

- Smartphone use: the time a student spends on the phone in one day, for any purpose.
- Study habits: the regular ways a student studies, such as study time, focus and finishing work on time.
- Concentration: how well a student can keep attention on the study task without being distracted.
- Survey: a way of collecting data by asking a group of people the same set of questions.

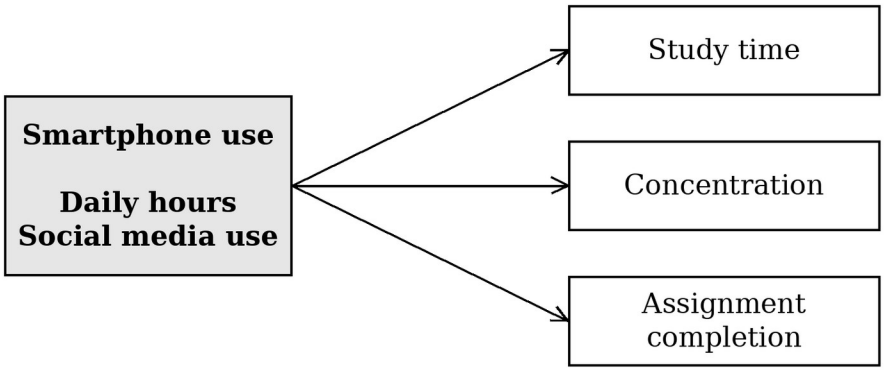


Figure 1.1 Conceptual framework of the study

Figure 1.1 shows the idea of the study: smartphone use is the independent variable, and the three parts of study habits are the dependent variables that we expect to be affected.

1.10 Outline of the Methodology

This study will follow a quantitative survey method. First, we will prepare a short questionnaire with simple questions about phone use and study habits. Second, we will check the questions with a few students to make sure they are clear. Third, we will collect the responses from a sample of students of the department, in printed form or through an online form. The sample size will be decided with our supervisor.

Finally, we will analyze the data. We will use average and percentage to describe the students, charts to show the results, and a correlation test to check the relationship between phone use and each part of study habits. The full details of the method will be given in Chapter III.

1.11 Organization of the Thesis

This thesis is planned in five chapters. Chapter I is the introduction, which explains the background, the research gap, the questions, the objectives and the hypotheses. Chapter II is the literature review, which discusses earlier studies and shows the gap that our work tries to fill. Chapter III explains the research methodology in detail. Chapter IV presents the results and discusses them. Chapter V concludes the thesis and gives some ideas for future work. The references are given at the end of the report.